

Church Membership

This lesson is the fourth in the series entitled “The Beginner’s Bible Study.” Other lessons in this series can be obtained through the Lehigh Valley Baptist Church.

The lessons are designed to be first studied, then the questions in the back answered, and then reviewed with the help of an older Christian.

***“As ye have therefore received Christ Jesus
the Lord, so walk ye in Him.”***

Colossians 2:6

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What does the Bible say about church membership? In Ephesians 3:21 the Bible says, *“Unto Him be glory in the church by Christ Jesus throughout all ages, world without end, Amen.”*

What does it mean to give glory to God? What does that term glory mean? It means to give the honor that is due to His name. God has ordained that His glory will be given in the church. God has ordained that we give Him glory in a specific place, in a specific locality. When God gave the law He told the Old Testament saints in the book of Deuteronomy, “I want you to give Me glory, but I want My glory to be in a particular place. There is a place where you will meet with Me, and that is the place I will ordain that offerings and sacrifices are to be given.” This was the Tabernacle, a tent-like structure that was moved from place to place. God eventually chose, of course, Jerusalem where the temple was to be set up permanently.

But in the New Testament age in which we live, God has determined that it is through the church that He is to get glory. In I Timothy 3:15 the Bible says, *“But if I tarry long, that thou mayest know how thou oughtest to behave thyself in the house of God, which is the church of the living God, the pillar and ground of the truth.”* Paul is writing to young Timothy and he is saying, “Timothy, in case I don’t get there in time, or in case something happens that I don’t get there, I want you to know how you ought to behave yourself in the house of God.” The house of God is the church of the living God. In other words, it is the New Testament church. And that church, He says, is the pillar and ground of the truth. A pillar is nothing more than something that upholds that which is on top of it. The Bible says here the truth is to be upheld by the pillar of the church.

A person may say, “Preacher, I believe you can be a Christian and you don’t need a church to be a Christian.” I would agree that you can be a saved person without the church, but I deny you can be a Christian. For a Christian, in the New Testament, is one who is Christ-like, one who follows Jesus Christ. I deny that you can be a Christian, living for Christ, portraying Christ properly in your life unless you do it through a local, New Testament church.

INAUGURATION OF THE CHURCH

If the church is the pillar that holds up the truth, then the church is a pretty important matter. Because if you don’t have the right pillar underneath the roof, it will eventually fall on top of you. In a lot of places there are churches that are not the right kind of church, or the right kind of pillar. Consequently the truth it should be upholding eventually fell through, and was scattered. There are people who have lost the opportunity to know the truth because they were not in a right kind of a New Testament church.

First of all, we read in Matthew 16, that Jesus Christ started His church. He says in verse 18, *“And I say also unto thee, That thou art Peter, and upon this rock I will build my church; and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it.”* Jesus is not only saying there is going to be a church around until He comes again, but He is saying in this passage of Scripture, *“I will build my church.”* Whatever church we should find to attend should be like the one He started.

Second of all, we are saying that Jesus started His church so we must be able to find a place where He started it. In Matthew 4, we find the starting of the church of the Lord Jesus Christ. It says in verses 17-22, *“From that time Jesus began to preach, and to say, Repent:*

for the kingdom of heaven is at hand. And Jesus, walking by the sea of Galilee, saw two brethren, Simon called Peter, and Andrew his brother, casting a net into the sea: for they were fishers. And he saith unto them, Follow me, and I will make you fishers of men. And they straightway left their nets, and followed him. And going on from thence, he saw other two brethren, James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother, in a ship with Zebedee their father, mending their nets; and he called them. And they immediately left the ship and their father, and followed him.”

Here we have the beginning of a New Testament church. It begins here with some men who were saved, Peter and Andrew. We read in John 1 how they got saved and followed the Lord. John the Baptist baptized them. Jesus came by while they were taking care of some fishing jobs, and said to them, “You come follow me, and I will make you fishers—not of fish—but I’ll make you fishers of men. I’ll make you soul winners.” What did they do immediately when they received the call? Immediately, the Bible says, they left their nets and they went and followed Him.

What is the simplest Bible definition of a church? A church is saved people who have been baptized, called out of the world in order to gather together and carry out the Great Commission of winning people to Jesus Christ. We come out of this world, and we gather together for the sake of fellowship, encouragement, teaching, organizing and then preparation. In turn, we can go back out into the world and gather more people for Christ and bring them back. Our job is fishing for men. This is the kind of a church that Jesus started. Jesus started a church of men who were saved, baptized, gathered together for the purpose of winning men to Christ.

CONTINUATION OF THE CHURCH

You may ask, “Okay, Preacher, Jesus says He started His church, but what are the chances that church is still in existence today?” And we would have to say, if you went over to Jerusalem today, you probably wouldn’t find this particular church in Jerusalem. No, they got scattered abroad as we find in the book of Acts. So you say, “Where am I going to find a church like that, and is there such a thing any more in existence?” Yes, there absolutely is.

Let’s look again at the verse we just read, Matthew 16:18. Jesus is doing the speaking, He says there, *“And I say also unto thee, That thou art Peter, and upon this rock I will build my church; and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it.”* Jesus promised the gates of hell wouldn’t prevail against His church. In other words, it’s going to continue and exist.

In Matthew 28:16, Jesus is talking to the eleven disciples which made up His church. He gives them the commission in verse 19, *“Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost: Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you.”* The Great Commission is three-fold to the local church. The commission begins with winning people and teaching them, number two baptizing them, and number three training them in all things, teaching them all things that they may continue to live for Christ. But don’t stop reading there. Read the rest of that verse, in verse 20, *“...and, lo, I am with you alway, even unto the end of the world. Amen.”*

If Jesus was talking to His church in verse 16 (which He was, down through verse 20), then when He says, “I am going to be with you

until the end of the world” what is He saying? He is saying, “This church that I am giving this job to, this commission to, is also going to be around. In other words, there are going to be churches like this until the coming of the Lord Jesus Christ.” Our text that we read in the book of Ephesians 3:21 is another text which is very clear in the same matter. It says, *“Unto Him be glory in the church by Christ Jesus throughout all ages, world without end. Amen.”*

If Jesus has said, “I’m going to get glory throughout all the ages through the church,” then if there isn’t a church, is He going to be able to get glory at the time when there isn’t a church? There will be no glory for God, if He has ordained through the ages He’s going to get glory through the church. If there is no church, then it stands to reason He gets no glory.

So what we are saying is this. The Bible teaches that Jesus started a New Testament church, a local assembly. Second of all the Bible tells us that not only did He start it during His earthly ministry, but there will be churches throughout the years to come until He comes to call us home. That’s the promise of the Word of God.

DESCRIPTION OF THE CHURCH

What kind of a church is this going to be which you and I can be members of in order to help give Him glory? The answer starts off, first of all, with the meaning of the word church. A church is not some invisible, spooky thing that is out there. It is not a denomination, it’s not becoming a Baptist, or becoming a Nazarene, or becoming a Catholic. But a church is a local assembly. It is something that gathers in one particular location, called out to assemble. That’s what the word church means, to call out and assemble someplace.

The Bible then puts perfect clarification on it and calls it “the Lord’s church,” and “the Lord’s assembly.” They are saved people that have been baptized, and are organized for the purpose of doing a particular thing, of carrying out the Great Commission. This is what the Bible teaches about a church.

So what kind of a church should I be looking for if I am looking for a church home? There are many things we could look at, but we are going to look at some basic truths.

The Church’s Head—Jesus Christ

In Colossians 1:18-19 the Bible, talking about Christ says, *“And he is the head of the body, the church: who is the beginning, the firstborn from the dead; that in all things he might have the pre-eminence. For it pleased the Father that in him should all fullness dwell.”* In this verse of Scripture we learn, first of all, Jesus Christ is the head of the body. The body is the local church. As the head, He is the one that is to get the attention. He is the one who is to be “number one” in the church.

In Ephesians 1:22-23 the Bible says that God *“...hath put all things under his feet, and gave him to be the head over all things to the church, Which is his body, the fullness of him that filleth all in all.”* Here the Bible again tells us that God has put everything under the feet of the church and the church is the body, and the head of that body is none other than the Lord Jesus Christ. He is the one that fills the church. He is the one that is to be in charge of the church.

And so we learn that the head of every New Testament church is not some fellow that sits in Rome, or Nashville, or Tennessee, or Greenville, or Springfield, Missouri. The head of the church, my

friend, is not some fellow who sits in some office and cocks his feet back and smokes his cigars and pops out reports and says, “Send me all of your money!” The head of the church is none other than the Lord Jesus Christ. He is the one who is to be in charge of a New Testament church. If a church has any other kind of a head than that, then it is not the church of the Lord Jesus Christ.

The Church’s Organization—Independent

Second of all, we gather from these verses that church will then be independent. By that we mean not attached to other groups or to other churches that have control over it. They are not in a position to where others can reach their tentacles in from the outside and say, “Here’s what you must do.”

There are some groups and denominations that actually control the building programs of a local congregation. They control what is said from the pulpit. They pick who the pastor is, and what men are going to run the church, and tell the church when they are going to have their services and when they are not. Some particular denominations run every single aspect of a local congregation’s meeting. Yet the Bible teaches here that the head of the church is Jesus Christ and a church is to be independent, not controlled by any outside organization.

So I would look for a church whose head is Christ and they are really responsive to the Him. Number two, I’d look for a church that’s independent, not owned by any groups or joined to some organization. We are the body of the Lord Jesus Christ in the Lehigh Valley. Therefore we have a responsibility to represent Him properly in this area. We don’t need outside organizations to tell us how to do that. We need to listen to Him.

The Church's Order—Congregational Rule

In Acts 6:1-7 we see the story of the setting aside of deacons for the first time in the church of Jerusalem. Starting in verse 1 it says, *“And in those days, when the number of the disciples was multiplied, there arose a murmuring of the Grecians against the Hebrews, because their widows were neglected in the daily ministration. Then the twelve called the multitude of the disciples unto them, and said, It is not reason that we should leave the word of God, and serve tables. Wherefore, brethren, look ye out among you seven men of honest report, full of the Holy Ghost and wisdom, whom we may appoint over this business. But we will give ourselves continually to prayer, and to the ministry of the word. And the saying pleased the whole multitude: and they chose Stephen, a man full of faith and of the Holy Ghost, and Philip, and Prochorus and Nicanor, and Timon, and Parmenas, and Nicolas a proselyte of Antioch: Whom they set before the apostles: and when they had prayed, they laid their hands on them. And the word of God increased...”*

The church of Jerusalem had a problem. They had Hebrew people and Greek people who had been saved and some of the ladies who were up in years were widows. There was money in the church that was given for their care, to help them out. Some of the Greek ladies said, “You know this isn’t quite fair. I’ve noticed that those preachers are Hebrews. They favor the Hebrew ladies in our church and they don’t fellowship with us enough and they are not properly caring for us.” They began to murmur.

So the apostles got together and said, “This isn’t going to work very well. We must figure out what to do.” So they got together and came up with an idea and went to the church. They said, “Okay, here’s

what we are going to do. We want to elect some men (they ultimately call them deacons in the book of I Timothy). We want to set some men aside for this job of taking care of these ladies, of serving the tables.”

The deacon’s position came into being out of a need that a local church had. The apostles were so busy trying to take care of the reading of the Word of God, the study of the Word of God, prayer, preaching and taking care of the spiritual labors within the church, they didn’t have the time to properly give attention to some of the financial duties. So the church elected these men. A denomination did not come in and tell them what to do. It was not the preachers coming and saying, “Here is what we are going to do,” but it was the people who elected the men, who set those men apart and said, “These are the men that we choose.”

But notice also the apostles said, “After you have chosen the men we will do the setting aside, or the setting apart.” In other words, the apostles had the final veto power to say yes or no to these men. They gave some qualifications of the men’s lives. Notice, it was not that they had to be rich, smart and important. They had to be men that were full of the Holy Ghost and loved the Lord Jesus Christ and were soul winners.

This is congregational rule. This is a congregation doing the voting, having its own choice, having its own word in the matter. The congregation has a responsibility to have a say in the ongoing of a New Testament church. That is exactly what took place here. Remember what we said about the church, not only is the head Christ, and secondly it is independent, but third of all, now we are saying that it has congregational rule. Because it has congregational rule, that enforces the fact that it is independent.

We don't go outside to get somebody else to run our church for us, we run it from inside as the Lord Jesus Christ gives us direction. In Matthew 18:17-18 the Bible says, *"And if he shall neglect to hear them, tell it unto the church: but if he neglect to hear the church, let him be unto thee as an heathen man and a publican. Verily I say unto you, Whatsoever ye shall bind on earth shall be bound in heaven: and whatsoever ye shall loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven."*

The church has the final say on a member staying in or going out. The church has the final say, if a man falls in sin and the church must deal with that, to be able to say, "We are sorry, we must separate fellowship with you." They have the final say and the final responsibility to deal with a matter of church discipline. This is church authority. This is not denominational authority. It's not some other man outside who comes in, but it is the church's ruling of itself under the headship of the Lord Jesus Christ.

The Church's Outreach—Missions

The fourth thing that will characterize a New Testament church is their mission outreach. Acts 13:1-4 says, *"Now there were in the church that was at Antioch certain prophets and teachers; as Barnabas, and Simeon that was called Niger, and Lucius of Cyrene, and Manaen, which had been brought up with Herod the tetrarch, and Saul. As they ministered to the Lord, and fasted, the Holy Ghost said, Separate me Barnabas and Saul for the work whereunto I have called them. And when they had fasted and prayed, and laid their hands on them, they sent them away. So they, being sent forth by the Holy Ghost, departed unto Seleucia; and from thence they sailed to Cyprus."*

We notice here the headship of Christ. It's the Holy Spirit who does the leading. We notice secondly the congregational rule in the fact that it is the congregation that sets them aside and sends them forth in verse 3. And we notice their independence in the fact that they didn't write to the church at Jerusalem and say, "Can we do this?" They just sent them out.

So here we have the fourth characteristic: A true New Testament church handles it's own missions program. They don't bottle up their money and send it off to an office somewhere. They determine where God would have them put their money, and who God would have them send to the mission field. And they, in turn, send out their missionaries and finance missionary programs as God gives them direction as a church body.

The Church's Officers—Pastors and Deacons

We are asking ourselves, "What does a New Testament church look like?" I Timothy 3:1-8, tells us that a New Testament church has two offices, and two offices only. The first office in a New Testament church is that of a bishop or pastor. Verse 1, *"This is a true saying, If a man desire the office of a bishop, he desireth a good work. A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife..."* So he gives the qualifications of a pastor. A pastor in scripture is called a bishop, an elder, and several other names.

Then the second office in the New Testament church is found in verse 8. *"Likewise must the deacons be grave, not doubletongued, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre..."* The second office in the New Testament church is that of a deacon.

There are only two offices that the New Testament sets aside for a local New Testament church. When you find a church that has a board of elders that helps to run the church on top of that, you have not found a church of the Lord Jesus Christ. You have found something that is the invention of men. When you find an organization that is run by presbyters, you have not found a local, New Testament church. A New Testament church has a pastor and a New Testament church has deacons. Those are the only two offices found in scripture.

The Church's Ordinances—Baptism and the Lord's Supper

There are only two ordinances practiced in a New Testament church. The first ordinance is in Matthew 28:18, “...*baptize them in the name of the Father, Son and Holy Ghost.*” After a person is saved, they are to be baptized. Baptism is an ordinance—not a sacrament. A sacrament is practiced by the Catholic church, and they say it gives grace to the people who receive it. So they say baptism, as a sacrament, washes away your sin. But we know that the Bible does not teach that. An ordinance, on the other hand, is nothing more than a symbol. It has no saving power, no ability to wash away sin, but it is something that is commanded by God for every saved child of God. We must be baptized, because God has commanded it. We are not to be baptized in order to go to heaven. We must be baptized in order to please the Lord Jesus Christ as a child of God. “What if I don’t get baptized?” you ask. If you are really saved, you will still go to heaven. But you will go to heaven as a disobedient child of God.

The second ordinance found in the scripture is in I Corinthians 11:22-26, the Lord’s Supper or the Lord’s Table. The Lord’s Table is very simply a celebrating and remembrance of the Lord’s death.

It is an ordinance, again, not a sacrament. If you never take the Lord's Supper, you'll still go to heaven if you are saved. If you are not saved you can take the Lord's Supper all you want, you can make a meal out of it, if you like. But it will not get you any closer to heaven, it will not wash away your sins.

The Church's Obligation—Discipleship of New Believers

The seventh thing about a New Testament church in the Bible is also found in Matthew 28:18-20. A New Testament Church will endeavor to win people to Jesus Christ. They will have a thirst of wanting to bring people to Christ. But they do more than just winning people to Christ. A New Testament Church will also endeavor to get them to follow the Lord in baptism once they have been saved. And third of all, they will then endeavor to train them so they can live a Godly Christian life. Any church that does not do those three things is not a church of the Lord Jesus Christ. It is just an organization.

I thank God for everybody that is saved, but a group that just gets them saved is not a church. A church, my friend, not only brings people to Christ, but a church then teaches them they need to obey Christ and follow the Lord in baptism. Then they teach them how to live for Christ and how to reproduce themselves. That, my friend, is a New Testament Church. Anything less may be a wonderful organization. But in the eyes of God it is not a New Testament Church.

The Church's Observation—Preaches Entire Bible

Then, in Acts 20:27 the Scriptures say, *"For I have not shunned to declare unto you all the counsel of God."* A New Testament Church is going to preach the whole Bible. They're going to preach it from

cover to cover. They are going to preach on subjects you like. But also they are going to preach on some subjects that you aren't going to like. It's going to hit some areas where it is going to step on your toes, and yet at other times areas that may soothe and comfort and console. Every area of the Bible ought to be declared faithfully because the Bible is the Word of God.

The Church's Objective—Separated Unto Christ

Then, number nine, in II Corinthians 6 we see that a New Testament Church will preach and strive for Godliness in its member's lives. In verses 14 and 17 the Bible says, *“Be ye not unequally yoked together with unbelievers: for what fellowship hath righteousness with unrighteousness? and what communion hath light with darkness? ...wherefore come out from among them, and be ye separate, saith the Lord, and touch not the unclean thing; and I will receive you.”*

The Lord tells us here that a New Testament Church will be a separated church—a church that stands on some principles and has some standards. They stand up for what is right and call sin black and not white, not gray, but names it for what it is.

A New Testament Church strives for Godliness in the members' lives. It doesn't mean you have to be perfect to come inside. If that was the case each of us would have to walk out the door right now and we would have an empty room. But it means that we are desiring as a church to be growing in Godliness. We want to be living a more Godly life for Christ next year than we are now.

DECISION CONCERNING THE CHURCH

Now, what does all of this mean to me? How should I respond? What do I do about it? There are three things.

Join a New Testament church.

As a saved child of God, you should be a member of a church. Let me give you some scriptures. In Acts 2:41 the Bible says, *“Then they that gladly received his word were baptized: and the same day there were added unto them about three thousand souls.”* What were they added to? Verse 47 says, *“Praising God, and having favor with all the people. And the Lord added to the church daily such as should be saved.”*

God thought it was important enough to include it in the Word of God that when these folks got saved and baptized He added them to the church. In I Corinthians 12:18, the Bible says, *“But now hath God set the members every one of them in the body, as it hath pleased him.”* God is the one who adds to the church. The body is the church. God is the one that adds to the body. God is the one that adds to the church. He thinks that it is important that a person be a member of a New Testament Church.

In Matthew 12:30 the Bible says, *“He that is not with me is against me.”* My friend, may I also make an application of that scripture? The one that is not with the local church is not for it, and they are not neutral. They are against it according to the scripture. God says, *“He that is not with me is against me.”* That is true in the spiritual realm in standing with the Lord Jesus Christ and I think it is also true when it comes to standing with His Church.

Love your New Testament church.

You not only should join a New Testament Church, but you should love that church you are a member of. In Ephesians 5: 25 it says, *“Husbands, love your wives, even as Christ also loved the church, and gave himself for it.”* If Jesus Christ loved the church, should you and I do any less than He did? Should you and I be involved in any less of a way than He was? How can we be against the things He is for and call ourselves Christians? If Jesus loved the church enough to give Himself for it, I believe you and I ought to love our church enough to give ourselves to it. We ought to love our church.

Support your New Testament church.

Attend your Church.

There are several ways we support it. Hebrews 10:25 says, *“Not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together, as the manner of some is.”* By attending church you are supporting it. By not attending it, do you know what you are doing? You are casting a vote to close it down.

Tonight I had a call from one of the members. He said, “Preacher, I am not going to be able to make it tonight, I just wanted to let you know so you wouldn’t be looking for me. I will be back, but something came up tonight and I won’t be able to make it.” Now, I’d rather every member was here. But I appreciate a great deal when a church member lets me know if they aren’t going to make it. When somebody doesn’t show up, I wonder where in the world they are. I wonder what’s happened to them. And other people wonder what’s happened to them. Where did they go? What are they doing? So, my friend, you ought to attend regularly.

Pray for your Church.

"God forbid that I should sin against the Lord in ceasing to pray for you..." Samuel said in I Samuel 12:23. I believe that truth is also true in the New Testament. We ought to pray for one another as scripture says. We ought to be praying for the church.

Serve in your Church.

In Romans 12:3-8 the Bible talks about being put into the body and every member has different gifts. Each one of us has gifts that we can add to this church and we ought to use those gifts. Exercise those gifts within this church in order to serve the Lord more fully and more faithfully.

Give to your Church.

We should support the church with our money. I believe that a person that doesn't give their money is really telling you where their heart is. In fact, may I dare say exactly what Jesus Christ said in Matthew 6? He said, *"Where your treasure is, there will your heart be also."* We know where your heart is by where you give. You know where your heart is by how you give.

The Bible teaches in I Corinthians 16:1-2 not to send your money to the church. The Bible says to "lay it aside," to bring it. Malachi 3 says to bring it to the storehouse. I Corinthians 16 says *"...lay by you in store."* It is something that is done on the first day of the week, according to I Corinthians 16. Every Sunday you ought to be giving whatever your tithe is for that week. You may get paid every other week so one week you don't have any tithe to give. But the next week you are to give your tithe.

What is tithe? Genesis 14:20 says, *“And blessed be the most high God, which hath delivered thine enemies into thy hand. And he gave him tithes of all.”* This was money that was given from Abraham to Melchizedek. Hebrews 7:2 says, *“To whom also Abraham gave a tenth part of all.”* In Hebrews God defines what a tithe is. He says it is a tenth, or ten percent of your income. That is what a tithe is and that is what God requires of a child of God. We are taught this in Acts 4:35-37; 5:2; and I Corinthians 16:2.

CONCLUSION

Let's turn to Romans 15. I want you to see three more verses. We talked about what kind of a church you should join. We talked about the fact that God commands it. We talked about the facts of what you ought to do: You ought to join it, you ought to love it, and you ought to support it. Now in Romans 15:6 the Bible says, *“That ye may with one mind and one mouth glorify God, even the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ. Wherefore receive ye one another, as Christ also received us to the glory of God. Now I say that Jesus Christ was a minister of the circumcision for the truth of God, to confirm the promises made unto the fathers; and that the Gentiles might, glorify God for his mercy; as it is written, For this cause I will confess to thee among the Gentiles, and sing unto thy name.”* The Bible says here that saved people are saved for the purpose of glorifying God. In I Corinthians 6:20, The Bible says, *“For ye are bought with a price: therefore, glorify God in your body, and in your spirit, which are God's.”* Our job is to glorify God. Turn to Ephesians 3:21. The Bible says *“Unto him be glory in the church by Christ Jesus throughout all ages, world without end Amen.”*

God's desire for your life and mine now that we know the Lord Jesus Christ as our Savior is that we glorify Him. That is what He saved you for. He saved you that you might give honor to God. Yet He tells us here in His Word, very plainly, that the place where you are going to be able to give honor to Him is through your service in the local, New Testament Church.

I think it's important we serve the Lord out in the world, but without a church to help keep the fires hot, it is like pieces of coal or wood that you can't get going. I remember when I had a wood stove I used to get one piece of wood going and it would start burning for a little bit, but if I would walk away and let it sit too long it would soon burn out and be done. If I would put 5 or 10 or 20 little pieces of wood in there and get one of them going, pretty soon they would all be burning. Then I could throw logs on and they would begin to burn and heat the whole house. One little stick doesn't do much all by itself. One little stick will soon go out all by itself.

That is how I find it is in my life and in other Christian's lives as I watch them. If you get off by yourself you may burn for a little while, that's true. But your light will soon go out. If you get inside a New Testament Church that is preaching and teaching and living the Bible, you have some other Christians to "rub against" and when you get out of sorts they'll be there to help rub you back into the right sorts and right direction again. When they get out of sorts, you'll be there to help them along the way. That is what God intended for a New Testament Church. And that, my friend, is what He intends for every saved child of God, that we be a member serving through a New Testament Church.

QUESTIONS ABOUT CHURCH MEMBERSHIP

1. According to I Timothy 3:15, what is the pillar and ground of the truth?
2. Give a simple definition of a church.
3. Are there any churches today similar to the one Jesus began?
4. Give a scriptural reference supporting your answer.
5. What verse tells us that Christ is the head of the church?
6. Should the congregation of a church ever be allowed to make any decisions?
7. What are the two offices of a New Testament church?
8. An ordinance is nothing more than a symbol.
Circle One: TRUE or FALSE

9. List the two ordinances of a local New Testament Church:
10. According to Matthew 28:18-20, a New Testament church will endeavor to _____ people to Jesus Christ.
11. What did Paul the apostle declare in Acts 20:27?
12. What basic truth does II Corinthians 6:14-17 teach?
13. How long after salvation did folks wait to join a church:
- a. One year
 - b. Ten years
 - c. They didn't wait
14. Give the Scriptural reference showing that we should love the church of which we are a part.
15. List some ways in which a church member can support their local church: